

PEOPLE
INFORMED
SOCIETIES
STRONGER



IDEAS
PEOPLE
PROGRESS
A STRONGER INDIA

KNOW
TODAY
BUILD
TOMORROW

CURRENT AFFAIRS

DAILY DIGEST

07 SEPTEMBER 2026 | DAILY EDITION

IMPORTANT DEVELOPMENTS.
BROADER PERSPECTIVES.

NEWS THAT SHAPES A BETTER TOMORROW.



POLITY &
GOVERNANCE



ECONOMY



INTERNATIONAL
RELATIONS



ENVIRONMENT



SCIENCE &
TECHNOLOGY



AGRICULTURE



GEOGRAPHY



PUBLIC
POLICY

A
VIBRANT
DEMOCRACY
A BRIGHTER
TOMORROW



SCIENCE
SOLUTIONS
A SAFER
TOMORROW

CONSTITUTION
RIGHTS
OPPORTUNITIES
INCLUSION
PROGRESS

CLEANER
GREENER
HEALTHIER
TOMORROW

A MORE INFORMED INDIA
FOR A BRIGHTER TOMORROW.

FACTS TODAY. A STRONGER TOMORROW.

INDIA'S VULTURE CONSERVATION FROM CRISIS TO RECOVERY

Healthy Ecosystems | Safer Communities | A Vulture-friendly India

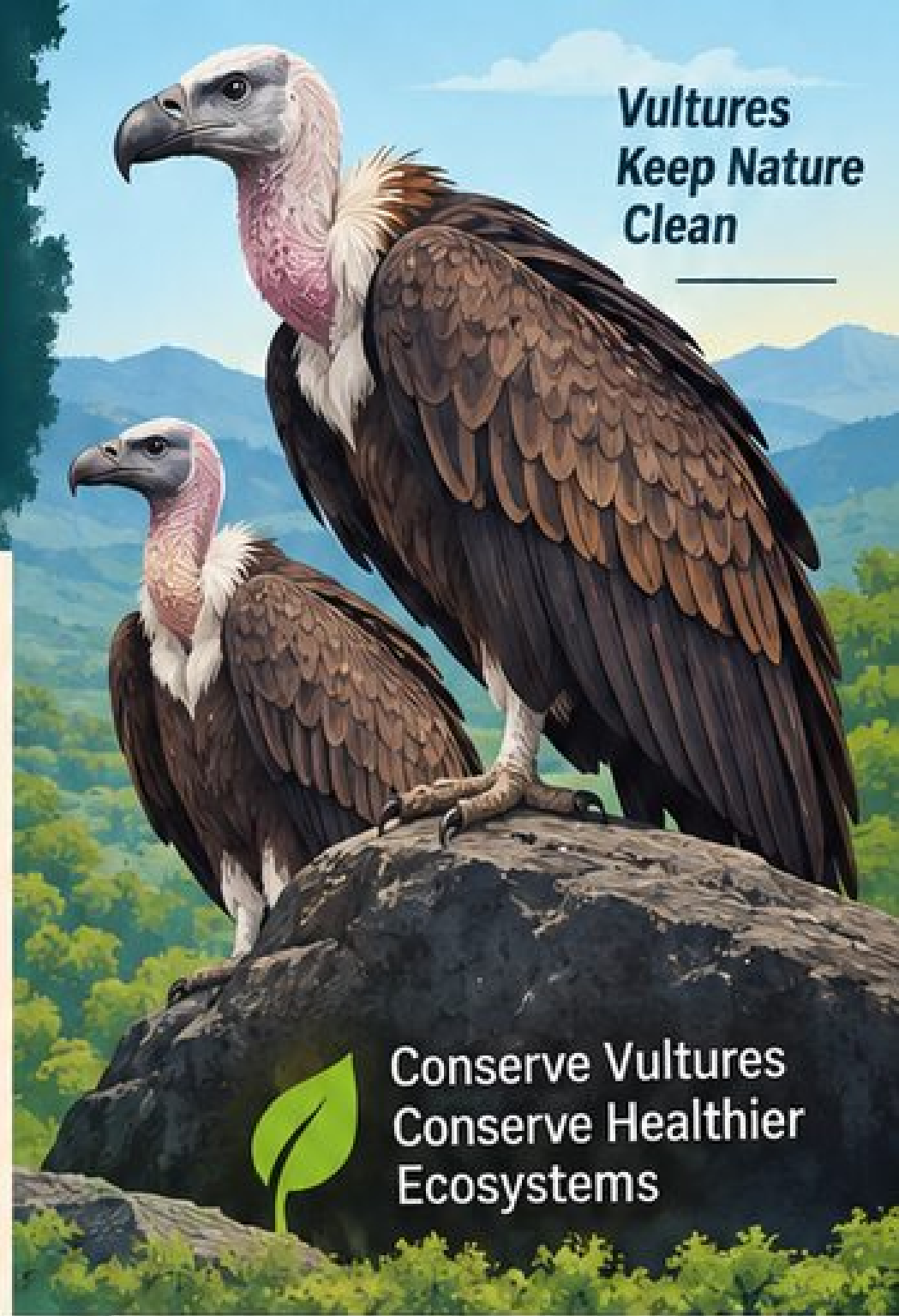
Vultures
Keep Nature
Clean

WHAT'S NEW?

6 September 2026



- Union Environment Minister inaugurated a national workshop at **Panchkula, Haryana** for **International Vulture Awareness Day 2026**.
- Workshop theme: **'From Crisis to Recovery – Conserving India's Vultures'**.
- Call for continued creation of **Vulture Safe Zones** and stronger technical capacity for species recovery in the wild.
- **Organised by:** Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Central Zoo Authority, Haryana Forest & Wildlife Department, Bombay Natural History Society, and Jatayu Conservation Breeding Centre at Pinjore.



WHY VULTURES MATTER



Scavengers rapidly dispose of carcasses.



Reduce disease risk for humans and livestock.



Help in nutrient cycling.



Indicator of ecosystem health.

WHY POPULATIONS CRASHED



Veterinary **diclofenac poisoning** through livestock carcasses was a major driver.



Habitat and food-chain pressures.



Unsafe carcass management and other threats.

VULTURE SAFE ZONE



- A landscape where threats are reduced, especially toxic veterinary drugs.
- Ensures safe food sources and proper carcass management.
- Involves monitoring, community participation and veterinary engagement.

INDIA FACTS

9

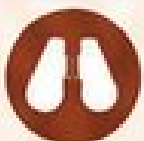
India has **nine vulture species**.

Examples:

- White-rumped Vulture
- Indian (Long-billed) Vulture
- Slender-billed Vulture
- Red-headed Vulture
- Egyptian Vulture
- Himalayan Griffon



CONSERVATION TOOLKIT



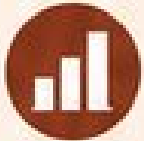
Captive breeding and reintroduction.



Drug safety and veterinary awareness (e.g. ban on diclofenac).



Habitat protection and safe carcass management.



Population monitoring and research.



Community participation and multi-stakeholder action.

PINJORE CENTRE



Jatayu Conservation Breeding Centre (JCBC) at Pinjore, Haryana

- A major conservation-breeding facility for vultures.
- In 2025–26, it housed **356 vultures** and bred **35 chicks**.



PRELIMS BOX



Vultures are birds of prey (raptors) and **scavengers**, not predators of live prey in normal circumstances.



Diclofenac residues in cattle carcasses can cause fatal kidney failure in vultures.



In-situ: Vulture Safe Zones (in the wild).
Ex-situ: Conservation breeding in facilities like JCBC, Pinjore.

Vultures Today
Healthier Tomorrows

SAVE VULTURES
SAVE ECOSYSTEMS
SAVE LIVES



INDIA'S BIODIVERSITY GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORK

CONSERVE TODAY. THRIVING TOMORROW.

PEOPLE
NATURE
SUSTAINABLE
INDIA

RICH
BIODIVERSITY
STRONGER
COMMUNITIES
A SUSTAINABLE
TOMORROW

BIODIVERSITY
SECURES
OUR FUTURE

WHAT'S NEW?



16th National Meet
held at **Chandigarh**



Focus: implementation
of biodiversity governance
at State & local levels



Brings together State
Biodiversity Boards and
UT Biodiversity Councils

LEGAL BACKBONE



Biological Diversity Act, 2002



Biological Diversity Rules



Access & Benefit Sharing (ABS)



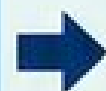
Conservation + sustainable use
+ fair benefit sharing

THREE-TIER INSTITUTIONAL STRUCTURE



National
Biodiversity
Authority (NBA)

NATIONAL LEVEL



State
Biodiversity
Boards (SBBs)

STATE LEVEL



Biodiversity
Management
Committees (BMCs)

LOCAL BODIES

PEOPLE'S BIODIVERSITY REGISTERS



Prepared locally by BMCs



Document local biological
resources



Record traditional knowledge
associated with biodiversity

ACCESS & BENEFIT SHARING



Ensures benefits from use of
biological resources are shared fairly



May include monetary and
non-monetary benefits



Links conservation with
community incentives

PRELIMS FACTS



NBA headquarters: **Chennai**



BMCs are constituted by local bodies



Biological diversity governance links
Centre, States and local institutions



India is a party to the Convention on
Biological Diversity (CBD)

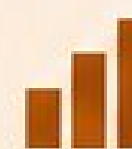
WHY LOCAL GOVERNANCE MATTERS



Conservation is site-specific



Communities hold ecological
and traditional knowledge



Local monitoring improves
implementation

BIODIVERSITY PEOPLE PROSPERITY

NATURE
INDIA
ALWAYS

RBI & EXCESS BANKING LIQUIDITY

WHY TOO MUCH MONEY CAN BE A PROBLEM

MORE LIQUIDITY TODAY. A BALANCED TOMORROW.



STABLE
BANKING
SYSTEM
STRONGER
INDIA

WHAT'S NEW?



₹10.3 lakh crore

Banking system liquidity
surplus (as on 3 Sept 2026)

Highest in about four years



RBI using **VRRR** to
absorb excess funds



₹6.02 lakh crore

absorbed on 4 Sept 2026
through **VRRR** auctions

WHAT IS LIQUIDITY?



- Funds readily available with banks.
- Surplus liquidity** = banks have more funds than immediate system demand.
- Deficit liquidity** = banks need RBI funding.

WHY EXCESS LIQUIDITY MATTERS



- Can push overnight money-market rates below policy repo rate.



- Weakens monetary-policy transmission.



- May add inflationary pressure if prolonged.



- Requires liquidity sterilisation / absorption.

RBI TOOLKIT TO MANAGE LIQUIDITY



Variable Rate Reverse Repo (VRRR)

Banks park funds with RBI at a variable auction-determined rate.



Standing Deposit Facility (SDF)

Absorbs liquidity without collateral.



Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR)

Portion of deposits kept with RBI (earns no interest).



Open Market Operations (OMO) and forex operations can alter rupee liquidity.

MONETARY POLICY CORRIDOR

Higher
rate

MSF

(Marginal Standing Facility)

Upper bound
of the corridor

Repo Rate

Policy signal
(mid-point)

Lower
rate

SDF

(Standing Deposit Facility)

Lower bound
of the corridor

WACR (Weighted Average Call Rate)
is RBI's operating target.

PRELIMS FACTS



Repo injects liquidity against collateral (to banks).



Reverse repo / VRRR-type operations absorb liquidity.



CRR balances earn no interest.



Sterilisation offsets the liquidity impact of forex intervention.

HOW FOREX INFLOWS LEAD TO EXCESS LIQUIDITY



Foreign
currency
inflows



RBI buys
dollars
(in forex market)



Rupees enter
the banking
system



Banking
liquidity
rises

Absorption tools (VRRR, SDF, CRR, OMO) pull surplus rupees back from the system.

SOUND MONEY. A STRONGER TOMORROW.

INDIA'S 3-YEAR ROADMAP FOR A DRUG-FREE INDIA

SAFER PEOPLE | STRONGER COMMUNITIES | A HEALTHIER NATION

SAY NO TO DRUGS
BUILD A BRIGHTER INDIA

1 WHAT'S NEW?



3-year roadmap:

July 2026 → July 2029



Goal: stronger national action against drug trafficking and substance abuse



Enforcement + coordination + prevention + rehabilitation

2 INDIA'S ANTI-DRUG ARCHITECTURE



Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB)

- Central coordinating and enforcement agency



Ministry of Home Affairs

- Key nodal ministry for narcotics control



State police and anti-narcotics units

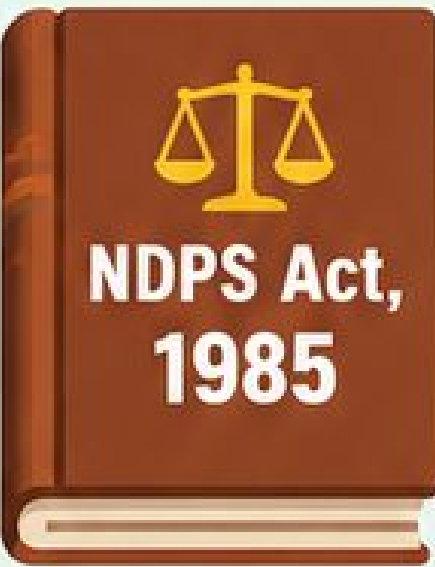
- Ground enforcement



Multi-agency coordination is essential

- Trafficking crosses borders and jurisdictions

3 LEGAL BACKBONE



- Controls and regulates narcotic drugs and psychotropic substances
- Provides stringent penalties for illicit trafficking
- Also permits regulated medical/scientific use under law

4 FOUR-PILLAR RESPONSE



Supply reduction

Disrupt trafficking networks



Demand reduction

Prevention and awareness



Treatment & rehabilitation

Support people with substance-use disorders



International cooperation

Intelligence and border coordination

5 WHY DRUG TRAFFICKING IS A SECURITY ISSUE



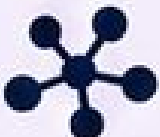
Organised crime networks



Cross-border trafficking



Money laundering and illicit finance



Potential links with other transnational crimes

6 PRELIMS FACTS



NCB established in 1986



NDPS = Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances



India is located between the **Golden Crescent** and **Golden Triangle** trafficking regions



Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan focuses on demand reduction and awareness

7 TRAFFICKING GEOGRAPHY

India's location makes it vulnerable due to proximity to two major illicit drug production regions.

GOLDEN CRESCENT

Afghanistan
Pakistan
Iran

INDIA

GOLDEN TRIANGLE

Myanmar
Laos
Thailand

Golden Crescent and Golden Triangle are major global centres of illicit drug production and trafficking.

SECURE BORDERS
SAFER TOMORROW

WESTERN ZONAL COUNCIL

CENTRE – STATE COORDINATION & COOPERATIVE FEDERALISM

DIALOGUE | COOPERATION | STRONGER STATES | A STRONGER INDIA

PANAJI
GOA

7 SEPT 2026

Stronger
Together
for a
Developed India



WHAT'S NEW?



28th Western Zonal Council meeting



Panaji, Goa — 7 Sept 2026



Platform for Centre–State and inter-State coordination



ZONAL COUNCILS

- Created under the **States Reorganisation Act, 1956**
- Statutory bodies — **NOT constitutional bodies**
- Five zonal councils: Northern, Central, Eastern, Western, Southern
- North Eastern Council is separate and governed by the NEC Act, 1971



WESTERN ZONAL COUNCIL MEMBERS

- Goa
- Gujarat
- Maharashtra
- Union Territory of Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu



WHO CHAIRS?

- Union Home Minister: common Chairman of the five Zonal Councils
- Chief Ministers of member States: Vice-Chairman by annual rotation
- Administrators/LG of member UTs participate



WHAT DO THEY DISCUSS?

- Inter-State issues
- Border, transport and infrastructure coordination
- Internal security
- Social and economic planning
- Implementation of national programmes



WHY THEY MATTER



Cooperative federalism



Consultation before conflict



Regional coordination



Faster resolution of shared administrative problems



PRELIMS TRAPS

- Zonal Councils ≠ Inter-State Council
- Inter-State Council: **Article 263** of Constitution
- Zonal Councils: **States Reorganisation Act, 1956**
- NEC is not one of the five Zonal Councils

7 SEPT 2026
NEW DELHI

A STRONGER PARTNERSHIP
FOR A STABLE AND PROSPEROUS
INDO-PACIFIC

PEACE
PROSPERITY
PEOPLE
PLANET

15th INDIA-JAPAN ANNUAL SUMMIT

STRONGER TIES FOR A SHARED FUTURE

 **WHEN & WHERE**
7 September 2026
New Delhi, India

 **LEADERS**
Prime Minister
Narendra Modi
& Prime Minister
Shigeru Ishiba

 **SIGNIFICANCE**
Reviewed progress,
set new goals and
reaffirmed commitment
to a free, open, inclusive
and rules-based
Indo-Pacific



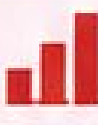
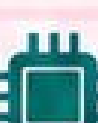
KEY OUTCOMES

 ENHANCED STRATEGIC COOPERATION Reaffirmed Special Strategic and Global Partnership	 ECONOMIC & INVESTMENT TIES Focus on resilient supply chains, clean energy, infrastructure and emerging technologies	 DEFENCE & SECURITY Greater collaboration in maritime security, cyber, space and defence industry	 GREEN & CLEAN ENERGY Cooperation on renewable energy, hydrogen, energy efficiency and climate action	 PEOPLE-TO-PEOPLE EXCHANGES Boost in education, skill development, tourism and cultural ties
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INDIA-JAPAN RELATIONS

- 1952 Establishment of diplomatic relations
- 2000 'Global Partnership'
- 2006 'Strategic and Global Partnership'
- 2014 Special Strategic and Global Partnership
- 2016 India-Japan Civil Nuclear Agreement
- 2017 Annual Summit mechanism
- 2022 70 years of diplomatic relations
- 2026 15th Annual Summit

MAJOR AREAS OF COOPERATION

-  **Trade & Investment**
Japan is a major source of FDI in India
-  **Infrastructure**
Flagship project: Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail (Bullet Train)
-  **Technology & Innovation**
Semiconductors, AI, digital, start-ups
-  **Maritime Cooperation**
Peace, security and stability in the Indo-Pacific
-  **Sustainable Development**
Clean energy, green hydrogen, resilient supply chains

 **INDO-PACIFIC VISION**
Both nations reiterated their commitment to a free, open, inclusive and rules-based Indo-Pacific, with respect for international law and freedom of navigation.



TWO DEMOCRACIES.
A BRIGHTER TOMORROW.

SMALL MODULAR REACTORS FOR ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ?

CLEAN ENERGY | STRONGER ISLANDS | A SECURE INDO-PACIFIC

SITE ASSESSMENT / PROPOSAL

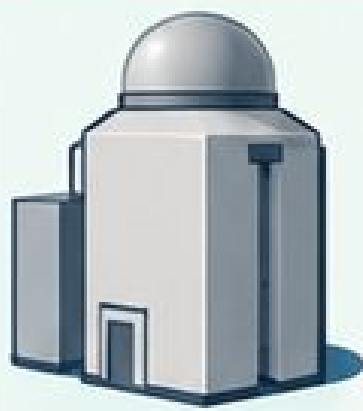
NOT YET AN OPERATING REACTOR

WHAT'S NEW?



- DAE/BARC team assessing sites across Andaman & Nicobar Islands
- Site assessments: **4-8 Sept 2026**
- Purpose: examine nuclear options for future island power demand

WHAT IS AN SMR ?



- **Small Modular Reactor**
- Typically up to **~300 MW(e)** per module
- Factory-fabricated modules can reduce on-site construction time
- Designed for scalable deployment

WHY ISLANDS ?



- Isolated grids
- High dependence on transported fuels
- Growing infrastructure and strategic power needs
- Need reliable low-carbon baseload alongside renewables/storage

INDIA'S NUCLEAR GOVERNANCE



सत्यमेव जयते

- | | |
|--------------|--|
| DAE | Department of Atomic Energy (Union government) |
| BARC | Nuclear R&D |
| NPCIL | Major nuclear power plant operator |
| AERB | Nuclear and radiation safety regulator |

STRATEGIC GEOGRAPHY



SMR: PROMISE vs CHALLENGES

PROMISE



Lower-carbon firm power



Modular scaling



Potential fit for smaller grids

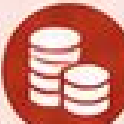
CHALLENGES



Safety & regulation



Radioactive waste management



High upfront economics



Island ecology & disaster resilience

PRELIMS FACTS



Nuclear energy is a Union List subject.



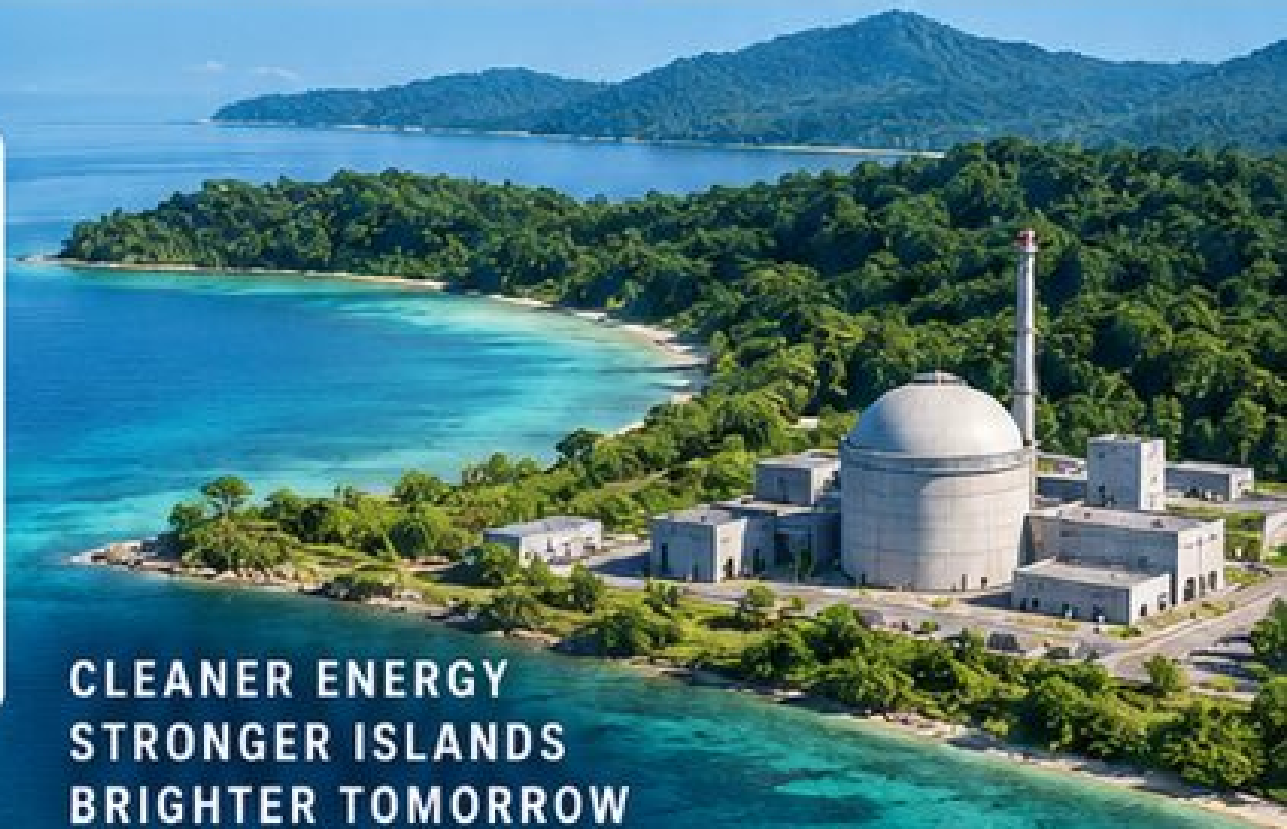
Atomic Energy Act, 1962 is a key law.



Fission releases energy by splitting heavy atomic nuclei.



SMR ≠ nuclear fusion.



CLEANER ENERGY
STRONGER ISLANDS
BRIGHTER TOMORROW

7 SEPT 2026
LATEST UPDATE

SIMPLER TAX. STRONGER INDIA.

GST 2.0

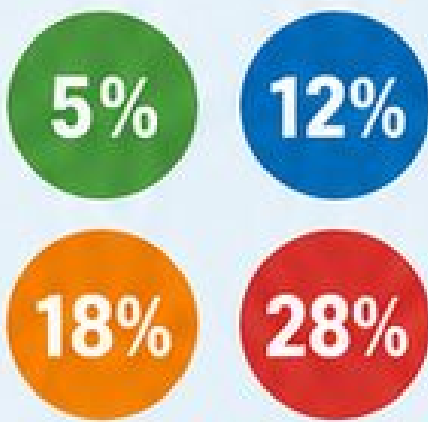
NEXT-GENERATION REFORM FOR A SIMPLER, FAIRER AND STRONGER ECONOMY

The GST Council has approved a simplified two-rate structure, sweeping rate rationalisation and key changes effective from **22 September 2026**.



FROM FOUR RATES TO TWO A SIMPLER GST STRUCTURE

EARLIER



NOW



WHAT CHANGES?

- Rate rationalisation across a large number of items
- Several goods and services shifted from 12% and 28% to 5% or 18%
- Aim to reduce classification disputes and compliance burden
- Expected to boost consumption, manufacturing and formalisation

GOODS AND SERVICES NOW AT 0%

- Specified lifesaving drugs and rare disease medicines
- Specified defence items
- Select educational materials

A separate list of 0% items has been notified.

WHAT GETS CHEAPER? LOWER TAX ON EVERYDAY ESSENTIALS

- Food items**
Many daily use items moved to 5%
- Healthcare**
Greater relief on medicines and medical devices
- Education**
Select items and services at 5%
- Agriculture**
Inputs and equipment cheaper
- Automobiles**
Small cars and two-wheelers attract lower tax

EXPECTED IMPACT

- Lower prices for households
- Higher demand and economic growth
- Support to MSMEs and job creation
- More competitive and self-reliant India

IMPLEMENTATION

- New rates effective from **22 September 2026**
- Detailed notifications and item-wise lists to be issued by the Government

SIMPLER COMPLIANCE • STRONGER BUSINESSES • BRIGHTER TOMORROW

INDIA-ASEAN SUMMIT 2026

STRONGER PARTNERSHIP FOR A STABLE, PROSPEROUS INDO-PACIFIC

India and ASEAN leaders held the 22nd India-ASEAN Summit, reaffirming their commitment to a peaceful, secure and rules-based Indo-Pacific.

22nd INDIA-ASEAN SUMMIT



7 September 2026



New Delhi, India



Leaders of all 10 ASEAN countries and the Prime Minister of India



22nd INDIA - ASEAN SUMMIT

7 SEPTEMBER 2026, NEW DELHI

ASEAN-India
A Partnership for Peace,
Progress and People



THEME

“ASEAN-India: A Partnership for Peace,
Progress and People”



PARTICIPATION

10 ASEAN member countries +
Prime Minister of India



KEY OUTCOMES

- Adopted a Joint Statement to further deepen the **Comprehensive Strategic Partnership**
- Reaffirmed commitment to a free, open, inclusive and rules-based Indo-Pacific
- Agreed to enhance cooperation in trade, connectivity, maritime security, digital transformation, clean energy, health and people-to-people ties
- Discussed regional and global issues of mutual interest



FOCUS AREAS



Trade & Investment



Maritime Security & Blue Economy



Digital Transformation &
Emerging Technologies



Green Transition & Clean Energy



People-to-People and
Cultural Exchanges



Counter-Terrorism, Cybersecurity
and Transnational Crime

WHAT IS ASEAN?

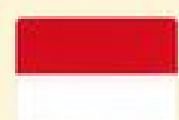
Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) is a regional organisation of 10 Southeast Asian countries, established in 1967 to promote peace, stability and economic cooperation in the region.



Brunei



Cambodia



Indonesia



Laos



Malaysia



Myanmar



Philippines



Singapore



Thailand



Vietnam



A stronger
India-ASEAN
partnership
contributes to a
more peaceful,
prosperous and
inclusive
Indo-Pacific.

INDIA–MAURITIUS ELEVATE TIES TO ENHANCED STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP

During the Mauritius Prime Minister's visit to India (4–9 September 2026), the two countries announced the elevation of bilateral ties to an **"Enhanced Strategic Partnership"**.



WHAT HAPPENED?

- India and Mauritius decided to upgrade their relationship to an **Enhanced Strategic Partnership**.
- Several agreements and MoUs signed across key areas of cooperation.
- Reaffirmed commitment to a free, open, inclusive and secure **Indian Ocean Region**.



*Stronger partners
for a stable, prosperous
Indian Ocean*



KEY AREAS OF COOPERATION



Maritime
Security &
Coastal Surveillance



Trade,
Investment &
Blue Economy



Digital Public
Infrastructure
& Innovation



Climate Change,
Disaster Resilience
& Renewable Energy



People-to-People
Ties, Education
& Capacity Building



SIGNIFICANCE

- Builds on a long-standing and close friendship.
- Strengthens cooperation in the Indian Ocean, a key region for India's security and economic interests.
- Supports Mauritius' development priorities and India's **MAHASAGAR vision** (Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions).



ABOUT MAURITIUS

- Island nation in the Indian Ocean, east of Madagascar.
- Strategic location along key maritime sea lanes.
- A close and trusted partner of India with strong people-to-people links (large Indian-origin population).
- Important for India's vision of a stable, secure and prosperous Indian Ocean Region.



**STRONGER INDIA–MAURITIUS TIES
FOR A PEACEFUL, INCLUSIVE AND PROSPEROUS INDIAN OCEAN**



FRONT-OF-PACK FOOD WARNING LABELS

INDIA'S POLICY DEBATE

HEALTHIER
PEOPLE
STRONGER
INDIA



WHAT'S NEW?



Supreme Court challenge to proposed food-warning framework filed by a public-health group (7 September 2026).



Issue: threshold design for front-of-pack warnings.



Hearing reported for 10 September 2026.

HOW THE PROPOSAL WORKS

Red warning proposed when at least 2 of 3 exceed limits:



Added sugar



Salt / Sodium



Saturated fat

Debate: should one excessive nutrient alone trigger a warning?

WHY FRONT-OF-PACK LABELLING?



Quick consumer information.



Supports healthier choices.



Targets diet-related non-communicable diseases (NCDs).



Complements detailed nutrition panels.

GOVERNANCE



FSSAI regulates food safety and standards.



Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006.



Ministry of Health & Family Welfare.



Supreme Court reviewing the challenge.



FOOD SAFETY
A HEALTHIER NATION
A STRONGER TOMORROW

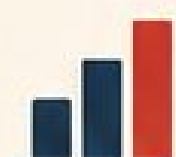
PUBLIC POLICY BALANCE



Consumer right to information.



Public health.



Scientific threshold-setting.



Compliance burden and food-industry impact.

PRELIMS FACTS

- FSSAI = Food Safety and Standards Authority of India.
- FSSAI is a statutory body.
- Food safety is governed principally by the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006.
- NCDs include cardiovascular disease, diabetes and some cancers.

GLOBAL CONCEPT



- Front-of-pack labels may use warnings, symbols or nutrient scores.
- Goal: make nutrition risk easier to understand at purchase.

Examples globally: warning labels (e.g., high in sugar), traffic light systems, or nutrient scores (e.g., Nutri-Score).



PROPOSAL UNDER COURT REVIEW
NOT A FINAL SUPREME COURT RULING

A HEALTHIER
FOOD ENVIRONMENT
BUILDS A HEALTHIER
TOMORROW